

thunderstorms continually vied with the artillery. To counter Sigel's 6,000 soldiers, Breckinridge had mustered a force of 4,000, including a reserve of 247 soaked and shivering cadets from the Virginia Military Institute, the "West Point of the South," who had arrived after marching 70 miles (112km) in four days from their Lexington school. Lee, who was accustomed to worse odds, had merely wished Breckinridge good luck: "I trust you will drive the enemy back."